PREP-RASHAN

A Unit of Prep-Rashan Tutorial

DAILY CURRENT AFFAIRS - RASHAN

Answers, Explanations & Elimination Techniques – 20 MCQs

12 November 2026

How to use: For each question you get the correct answer, the concept being tested, a check of every statement or pair, why each of the four options is right or wrong, and four ways to eliminate wrong options – logic, keywords, factual clues and conceptual understanding.

GS-I: General Studies Paper I

Q1. [GS-I | Yamuna river]

With reference to the Yamuna river, consider the following statements:

1. It rises from the Yamunotri Glacier in Uttarkashi district of Uttarakhand.
2. The Hindon is a right-bank tributary of the Yamuna.
3. The Yamuna joins the Ganga at Prayagraj.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

ANSWER: (c) 1 and 3 only

Concept behind the question: The Yamuna rises from the Yamunotri Glacier near the Bandarpunch peaks in Uttarkashi and joins the Ganga at Triveni Sangam, Prayagraj, after about 1,376 km. Its right-bank tributaries are the Tons, Chambal, Sindh, Betwa and Ken; the Hindon joins from the left bank.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ Statement 1	Correct.
✘ Statement 2	Wrong – the Hindon is a left-bank tributary.
✔ Statement 3	Correct.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*1 and 2 only* — Wrong – Statement 2 is incorrect.
(b)	*2 and 3 only* — Wrong – Statement 2 is incorrect.
(c)	*1 and 3 only* — **Correct – Statements 1 and 3.**
(d)	*1, 2 and 3* — Wrong – Statement 2 is incorrect.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** The Hindon flows through western Uttar Pradesh from the north-east side – the left bank; the big southern rivers join from the right.
- **Keywords:** Right bank: Tons, Chambal, Sindh, Betwa, Ken; left: Hindon, Giri.
- **Factual clue:** Yamuna is the Ganga's longest tributary.
- **Conceptual understanding:** River systems and their banks.

Trap to avoid: Mixing up right-bank and left-bank tributaries.
Remember: Southern (peninsular) rivers join the Yamuna from the right bank.

Q2. [GS-I | Yamuna tributaries]

Which one of the following is the largest Himalayan tributary of the Yamuna?

(a) Chambal
(b) Tons
(c) Betwa
(d) Hindon

ANSWER: (b) Tons

Concept behind the question: The Tons is the Yamuna's largest Himalayan tributary and adds a large volume of water at their meeting point. The Chambal and Betwa are right-bank tributaries from the peninsular side, and the Hindon is a left-bank tributary.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Chambal* — Wrong – a peninsular (non-Himalayan) tributary.
(b)	*Tons* — **Correct – the Tons.**
(c)	*Betwa* — Wrong – a peninsular tributary.
(d)	*Hindon* — Wrong – a smaller left-bank tributary.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** Chambal and Betwa rise in central India, so they cannot be Himalayan tributaries.
- **Keywords:** Tons – largest Himalayan tributary.
- **Factual clue:** The Yamuna basin spans seven States/UTs.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Himalayan vs peninsular tributaries.

Trap to avoid: Choosing the Chambal because it is the biggest overall.
Remember: Largest Himalayan tributary of the Yamuna = Tons.

Q3. [GS-I | Swachh Shehar Jodi]

The 'Swachh Shehar Jodi' initiative, recently seen in the news, is implemented under:

(a) AMRUT
(b) Smart Cities Mission
(c) Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana–Urban
(d) Swachh Bharat Mission–Urban

ANSWER: (d) Swachh Bharat Mission–Urban

Concept behind the question: The Swachh Shehar Jodi pairs a mentor city with a mentee city for a 100-day joint action plan on sanitation, based on 'Each One, Teach One'. It is run by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs under the Swachh Bharat Mission–Urban; 70 mentor cities were paired with 191 mentee cities.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*AMRUT* — Wrong – a water and sewerage mission.
(b)	*Smart Cities Mission* — Wrong – a different urban mission.
(c)	*Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana–Urban* — Wrong – an urban housing scheme.
(d)	*Swachh Bharat Mission–Urban* — **Correct – SBM-U.**

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** The word 'Swachh' points straight to the Swachh Bharat Mission.
- **Keywords:** Swachh Shehar Jodi → SBM-U (MoHUA).
- **Factual clue:** Top pair: Ahmedabad–Sanand.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Peer learning between cities.

Trap to avoid: Picking the Smart Cities Mission because cities are involved.
Remember: Swachh Shehar Jodi = SBM-U.

GS-II: General Studies Paper II

Q4. [GS-II | One Nation, One Ration Card]

With reference to the One Nation, One Ration Card (ONORC) scheme, consider the following statements:

1. It covers only beneficiaries under the National Food Security Act.
2. Most portability transactions under it are inter-State.
3. The Mera Ration mobile application is available in 13 languages.

How many of the statements given above are correct?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

ANSWER: (b) Only two

Concept behind the question: ONORC lets NFSA card holders draw grain from any fair price shop and now runs in all 36 States/UTs, with about 3.27 crore portability transactions a month. But only 0.7% of transactions are inter-State. The Mera Ration app works in 13 languages.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ Statement 1	Correct.
✘ Statement 2	Wrong – only 0.7% are inter-State.
✔ Statement 3	Correct.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Only one* — Wrong – two are correct.
(b)	*Only two* — **Correct – Statements 1 and 3.**
(c)	*All three* — Wrong – Statement 2 is incorrect.
(d)	*None* — Wrong – two are correct.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** The whole concern about ONORC today is that migrants rarely use it across States.
- **Keywords:** NFSA only; 0.7% inter-State; 13 languages.
- **Factual clue:** Over 233 crore transactions since launch.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Portability of welfare.

Trap to avoid: Assuming a scheme for migrants must be used mostly across States.
Remember: ONORC: inter-State share only 0.7%.

Q5. [GS-II | Rationalised visa regime]

Under India's rationalised visa regime, which one of the following visas is meant for AYUSH treatment?

(a) M-1
(b) M-2
(c) M-4
(d) M-3

ANSWER: (d) M-3

Concept behind the question: The Medical Visa has four sub-categories: M-1 (conventional treatment), M-2 (attendant of an M-1 holder), M-3 (AYUSH treatment) and M-4 (attendant of an M-3 holder). Main visa categories were cut from 13 to 9 and the Tourist Visa became the Visitor Visa.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*M-1* — Wrong – conventional treatment.
(b)	*M-2* — Wrong – attendant of M-1.
(c)	*M-4* — Wrong – attendant of M-3.
(d)	*M-3* — **Correct – AYUSH treatment.**

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** Attendant visas (M-2, M-4) follow the treatment visas they serve; M-4 serves M-3, so M-3 is the second treatment visa – AYUSH.
- **Keywords:** M-1 conventional; M-3 AYUSH.
- **Factual clue:** e-Visas for 172 countries.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Medical and AYUSH tourism.

Trap to avoid: Picking M-4 because it is the last number.
Remember: M-3 = AYUSH treatment visa.

Q6. [GS-II | Stand-Up India]

With reference to the Stand-Up India Scheme, consider the following statements:

1. It supports only new (greenfield) enterprises.
2. Loans range from ₹10 lakh to ₹1 crore.
3. It is administered by the Ministry of Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

ANSWER: (a) 1 and 2 only

Concept behind the question: Stand-Up India (5 April 2016) gives bank loans of ₹10 lakh to ₹1 crore to women, SC and ST entrepreneurs for greenfield units, covering up to 85% of the project cost. It is run by the Department of Financial Services, Ministry of Finance, and is now extended to 31 March 2031.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ Statement 1	Correct.
✔ Statement 2	Correct.
✘ Statement 3	Wrong – Department of Financial Services, Ministry of Finance.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*1 and 2 only* — **Correct – Statements 1 and 2.**
(b)	*2 and 3 only* — Wrong – Statement 3 is incorrect.
(c)	*1 and 3 only* — Wrong – Statement 2 is correct; 3 is not.
(d)	*1, 2 and 3* — Wrong – Statement 3 is incorrect.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** A scheme that works through bank branches is run by the Finance Ministry's banking department.
- **Keywords:** Greenfield; ₹10 lakh–₹1 crore; DFS.
- **Factual clue:** 85% credit guarantee; ₹4,111 crore corpus.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Financial inclusion of SC, ST and women.

Trap to avoid: Assuming every enterprise scheme belongs to the MSME Ministry.
Remember: Stand-Up India = Department of Financial Services.

Q7. [GS-II | ONORC – migrants]

Consider the following statements:

Statement-I: Inter-State transactions form a very small share of portability transactions under One Nation, One Ration Card.

Statement-II: Many migrant workers are unaware that they can draw their rations outside their home State.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

(a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I
(b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I
(c) Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect
(d) Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct

ANSWER: (a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I

Concept behind the question: Only 0.7% of ONORC transactions are inter-State. A major reason given is low awareness: many migrants do not know they can use their card in another State, and dependence on smartphones and digital literacy adds to it. So Statement-II explains Statement-I.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ Statement-I	Correct.
✔ Statement-II	Correct – and it explains I.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I* — **Correct – both true; II explains I.**
(b)	*Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I* — Wrong – II does explain I.
(c)	*Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect* — Wrong – II is also correct.
(d)	*Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct* — Wrong – I is correct.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** If people do not know about a facility, they will not use it – a direct cause.
- **Keywords:** 0.7% inter-State; low awareness.
- **Factual clue:** Mera Ration app helps check entitlement.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Awareness as a part of welfare delivery.

Trap to avoid: Marking (b) because there are other reasons too.
Remember: Low awareness is a direct cause of low inter-State use.

GS-III: General Studies Paper III

Q8. [GS-III | Clean power]

With reference to India's clean power transition, consider the following statements:

1. India met its target of 50% non-fossil installed power capacity in 2025.
2. Renewable sources supply more than half of India's actual electricity generation.
3. A 'thermal-mimic' auction seeks renewable power with storage that can be supplied on demand.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

ANSWER: (c) 1 and 3 only

Concept behind the question: Non-fossil sources were 54.2% of installed capacity by June 2026, and the 50% target was met in 2025 – five years early. But renewables give only about a quarter of actual generation. A thermal-mimic auction asks for renewable power plus storage that behaves like a coal plant; SECI's 1,000-MW tender got ₹5.25–5.26 a unit.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ Statement 1	Correct.
✘ Statement 2	Wrong – about a quarter.
✔ Statement 3	Correct.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*1 and 2 only* — Wrong – Statement 2 is incorrect.
(b)	*2 and 3 only* — Wrong – Statement 2 is incorrect.
(c)	*1 and 3 only* — **Correct – Statements 1 and 3.**
(d)	*1, 2 and 3* — Wrong – Statement 2 is incorrect.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** Installed capacity is not generation – solar works only part of the day, so its share of generation is much lower.
- **Keywords:** Capacity 54.2%; generation ~¼.
- **Factual clue:** Goal: 900 GW non-fossil by 2035.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Capacity vs generation.

Trap to avoid: Treating installed capacity share as generation share.
Remember: Over half of capacity, about a quarter of generation.

Q9. [GS-III | Black mass]

With reference to lithium-ion battery 'black mass', consider the following statements:

1. It is a finished battery-grade product ready for use in new cells.
2. It contains graphite from the battery's anode.
3. India has prohibited its export.

How many of the statements given above are correct?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

ANSWER: (b) Only two

Concept behind the question: Black mass is a dark powder obtained by discharging, dismantling and shredding used lithium-ion batteries. It holds lithium, nickel, cobalt and manganese from the cathode and graphite from the anode, but it is an intermediate that must be refined. The DGFT has changed its export policy from 'Free' to 'Prohibited'.

Checking each statement / pair

✘ Statement 1	Wrong – it is an intermediate.

✔ Statement 2	Correct.
✔ Statement 3	Correct.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Only one* — Wrong – two are correct.
(b)	*Only two* — **Correct – Statements 2 and 3.**
(c)	*All three* — Wrong – Statement 1 is incorrect.
(d)	*None* — Wrong – two are correct.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** A shredded powder must still be refined – it cannot be 'battery-grade'.
- **Keywords:** Intermediate; graphite; export banned.
- **Factual clue:** About 40–50% of an EV battery's weight.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Urban mining.

Trap to avoid: Thinking black mass is a final product.
Remember: Black mass = intermediate; export now prohibited.

Q10. [GS-III | Battery waste rules]

Extended Producer Responsibility (EPR) for batteries in India is laid down under the:

(a) Environment (Protection) Act, 1986 directly
(b) E-Waste (Management) Rules, 2016
(c) Hazardous Waste Rules, 1989
(d) Battery Waste Management Rules, 2022

ANSWER: (d) Battery Waste Management Rules, 2022

Concept behind the question: The Battery Waste Management Rules, 2022 set up an EPR framework that makes producers responsible for collecting and recycling battery waste and require a minimum share of recycled material in new batteries. A ₹1,500-crore scheme (September 2025) supports recovery of critical minerals from battery and e-waste.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Environment (Protection) Act, 1986 directly* — Wrong – the parent Act, not the rules.
(b)	*E-Waste (Management) Rules, 2016* — Wrong – older e-waste rules.
(c)	*Hazardous Waste Rules, 1989* — Wrong – old hazardous waste rules.
(d)	*Battery Waste Management Rules, 2022* — **Correct – BWMR 2022.**

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** A battery-specific duty comes from the battery-specific rules.
- **Keywords:** EPR for batteries → BWMR 2022.

- **Factual clue:** Recycled-content norms for new batteries.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Producer responsibility.

Trap to avoid: Choosing the e-waste rules.
Remember: Battery EPR = Battery Waste Management Rules, 2022.

Q11. [GS-III | Tax reform]

Consider the following statements regarding India's tax system:

1. Petroleum products are outside the Goods and Services Tax.
2. Taxpayers under the GST composition scheme can claim input tax credit.
3. 'Cascading' of taxes means tax being levied on tax already paid.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

ANSWER: (c) 1 and 3 only

Concept behind the question: Petroleum products are kept outside GST, so taxes on fuel cannot be set off and they cascade through transport costs. The composition scheme (turnover below ₹150 lakh) gives simpler compliance but no input tax credit. Cascading means tax on tax.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ Statement 1	Correct.
✘ Statement 2	Wrong – no input tax credit.
✔ Statement 3	Correct.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*1 and 2 only* — Wrong – Statement 2 is incorrect.
(b)	*2 and 3 only* — Wrong – Statement 2 is incorrect.
(c)	*1 and 3 only* — **Correct – Statements 1 and 3.**
(d)	*1, 2 and 3* — Wrong – Statement 2 is incorrect.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** The composition scheme trades lower compliance for loss of input tax credit – that is its known limitation.
- **Keywords:** Petroleum out; composition – no ITC.
- **Factual clue:** 148 goods (four-digit HSN) remain outside GST.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Tax neutrality.

Trap to avoid: Assuming every GST taxpayer gets input tax credit.
Remember: Composition scheme = no input tax credit.

Q12. [GS-III | CGFMU]

The Credit Guarantee Fund for Micro Units (CGFMU), recently extended to March 2031, is managed by:

(a) SIDBI
(b) NABARD
(c) Reserve Bank of India
(d) National Credit Guarantee Trustee Company

ANSWER: (d) National Credit Guarantee Trustee Company

Concept behind the question: CGFMU (January 2016) is managed by the National Credit Guarantee Trustee Company (NCGTC) under the Ministry of Finance. It guarantees Mudra loans up to ₹20 lakh, Jan Dhan overdrafts up to ₹10,000 and SHG loans. The guarantee fee for Mudra loans is cut from 1% to 0.75%.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*SIDBI* — Wrong.
(b)	*NABARD* — Wrong.
(c)	*Reserve Bank of India* — Wrong – the regulator, not a fund manager.
(d)	*National Credit Guarantee Trustee Company* — **Correct – NCGTC.**

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** Guarantee funds of the Finance Ministry are run by its trustee company, NCGTC.
- **Keywords:** CGFMU → NCGTC.
- **Factual clue:** New corpus ₹5,000 crore.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Risk sharing in lending.

Trap to avoid: Picking SIDBI because it is linked to MUDRA.
Remember: CGFMU = NCGTC.

Q13. [GS-III | Nutrient Based Subsidy]

With reference to the Nutrient Based Subsidy (NBS) scheme, consider the following statements:

1. Urea is covered under the scheme.
2. The subsidy on a fertiliser depends on its nutrient content.
3. It is administered by the Department of Fertilizers.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

ANSWER: (b) 2 and 3 only

Concept behind the question: NBS (since 1 April 2010) fixes a per-kg subsidy for N, P, K and S in phosphatic and potassic fertilisers, so a bag's subsidy follows its nutrient content. It is run by the Department of Fertilizers, Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers. Urea is outside NBS; its price is controlled separately.

Checking each statement / pair

✘ Statement 1	Wrong – urea is excluded.
✔ Statement 2	Correct.
✔ Statement 3	Correct.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*1 and 2 only* — Wrong – Statement 1 is incorrect.
(b)	*2 and 3 only* — **Correct – Statements 2 and 3.**
(c)	*1 and 3 only* — Wrong – Statement 1 is incorrect.
(d)	*1, 2 and 3* — Wrong – Statement 1 is incorrect.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** The main criticism of NBS is that urea stays outside it – so statement 1 must be wrong.
- **Keywords:** P&K only; urea excluded.
- **Factual clue:** Rabi 2026–27 outlay ₹62,370.02 crore.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Balanced fertilisation.

Trap to avoid: Assuming the biggest fertiliser must be in the biggest subsidy scheme.
Remember: NBS covers P&K, not urea.

Q14. [GS-III | CCPI]

The Climate Change Performance Index (CCPI) is published by:

(a) Germanwatch, NewClimate Institute and Climate Action Network International
(b) United Nations Environment Programme
(c) World Economic Forum
(d) Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change

ANSWER: (a) Germanwatch, NewClimate Institute and Climate Action Network International

Concept behind the question: The CCPI has been published every year since 2005 by Germanwatch, the NewClimate Institute and CAN International. In CCPI 2027 India fell to 28th (Medium); ranks 1–3 were left vacant and Denmark was 4th.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Germanwatch, NewClimate Institute and Climate Action Network International* — **Correct.**

(b)	*United Nations Environment Programme* — Wrong – UNEP publishes the Emissions Gap Report.
(c)	*World Economic Forum* — Wrong – WEF publishes other indices.
(d)	*Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change* — Wrong – IPCC writes assessment reports, not rankings.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** UN bodies rarely rank countries; the CCPI comes from non-governmental groups.
- **Keywords:** CCPI → Germanwatch + NewClimate + CAN.
- **Factual clue:** GHG emissions carry 40% weight.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Who publishes which index.

Trap to avoid: Picking UNEP for any climate report.
Remember: CCPI = Germanwatch, NewClimate Institute, CAN.

Q15. [GS-III | CCPI 2027 – vacant top ranks]

Consider the following statements:

Statement-I: In the Climate Change Performance Index 2027, the first three ranks were left vacant.

Statement-II: No country performed strongly enough in all four categories to be on a path consistent with 1.5°C.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

(a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I
(b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I
(c) Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect
(d) Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct

ANSWER: (a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I

Concept behind the question: The CCPI leaves ranks 1–3 empty because no country is on a 1.5°C-compatible path across emissions, renewable energy, energy use and climate policy. So the best country, Denmark, is ranked 4th. Statement-II gives the exact reason for Statement-I.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ **Statement-I**	Correct.
✔ **Statement-II**	Correct – and it explains I.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I* — **Correct – both true; II explains I.**
(b)	*Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I* — Wrong – II does explain I.
(c)	*Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect* — Wrong – II is also correct.

(d)	*Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct* — Wrong – I is correct.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** The vacant ranks exist only because no country meets the 1.5°C standard – a direct cause.
- **Keywords:** Ranks 1–3 vacant; Denmark 4th.
- **Factual clue:** UK 7th – the only G20 country rated High.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Benchmarking against Paris goals.

Trap to avoid: Marking (b) and missing the direct link.
Remember: Top three vacant because no one is on a 1.5°C path.

Q16. [GS-III | Railway safety – Kavach]

'Kavach', often seen in the news, is:

(a) A railway cyber-security firewall
(b) An indigenous automatic train protection system
(c) A crash-proof coach design
(d) A disaster-relief train service

ANSWER: (b) An indigenous automatic train protection system

Concept behind the question: Kavach is India's own automatic train protection system: it applies the brakes if a loco pilot over-speeds or passes a red signal. LHB coaches, with an anti-climb design, are a separate safety upgrade; the Rashtriya Rail Sanraksha Kosh is a non-lapsable safety fund.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*A railway cyber-security firewall* — Wrong.
(b)	*An indigenous automatic train protection system* — **Correct – automatic train protection.**
(c)	*A crash-proof coach design* — Wrong – that is the LHB coach.
(d)	*A disaster-relief train service* — Wrong.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** 'Kavach' means armour – a protective system that acts on its own.
- **Keywords:** Kavach = indigenous ATP.
- **Factual clue:** CAG: derailments ~75% of serious accidents (2017–21).
- **Conceptual understanding:** Technology for accident prevention.

Trap to avoid: Confusing Kavach with LHB coaches.
Remember: Kavach = automatic train protection.

Q17. [GS-III | Counter-terrorism in J&K]

Consider the following statements:

1. The Multi-Agency Centre is a platform for sharing intelligence among agencies.
2. The Comprehensive Integrated Border Management System uses smart fencing and sensors along the border.
3. Village Defence Guards are a Central Armed Police Force.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

ANSWER: (a) 1 and 2 only

Concept behind the question: The Multi-Agency Centre (MAC) shares intelligence among security agencies. CIBMS uses smart fencing, thermal imagers, underground sensors and anti-drone radars. Village Defence Guards are trained and armed local volunteers in vulnerable villages, not a central armed police force.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ Statement 1	Correct.
✔ Statement 2	Correct.
✘ Statement 3	Wrong – local volunteers.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*1 and 2 only* — **Correct – Statements 1 and 2.**
(b)	*2 and 3 only* — Wrong – Statement 3 is incorrect.
(c)	*1 and 3 only* — Wrong – Statement 2 is correct; 3 is not.
(d)	*1, 2 and 3* — Wrong – Statement 3 is incorrect.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** 'Village' guards are drawn from villages – they are local volunteers, not a central force.
- **Keywords:** MAC – intelligence; CIBMS – smart border; VDG – volunteers.
- **Factual clue:** UAPA and NIA act against terror financing.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Layered counter-terror strategy.

Trap to avoid: Treating every armed group as a CAPF.
Remember: VDGs = armed local volunteers.

Q18. [GS-III | Exercise Sea Vigil]

Consider the following statements:

Statement-I: Exercise Sea Vigil is a pan-India coastal defence exercise led by the Indian Navy.

Statement-II: Exercise Sea Vigil is a bilateral exercise between India and Sri Lanka.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

(a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I
(b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I
(c) Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect
(d) Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct

ANSWER: (c) Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect

Concept behind the question: Sea Vigil is a national exercise led by the Indian Navy with the Coast Guard, marine police, Customs, CISF, port authorities and fishing communities, covering the whole coastline and the EEZ. It was first held in January 2019 and is a precursor to TROPEX. It is not a bilateral exercise.

Checking each statement / pair

✔ Statement-I	Correct.
✘ Statement-II	Wrong – it is a national (pan-India) exercise.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I* — Wrong – II is incorrect.
(b)	*Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I* — Wrong – II is incorrect.
(c)	*Statement-I is correct but Statement-II is incorrect* — **Correct – I true, II false.**
(d)	*Statement-I is incorrect but Statement-II is correct* — Wrong – I is correct.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** 'Pan-India' and 'bilateral' cannot both be true of the same exercise.
- **Keywords:** Sea Vigil – national, Navy-led.
- **Factual clue:** Sea Vigil-26: 5th edition, 11–19 November 2026.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Coastal security after 26/11.

Trap to avoid: Assuming every naval exercise has a foreign partner.
Remember: Sea Vigil = pan-India, Navy-led.

Q19. [GS-III | Defence exercises]

Consider the following pairs (Exercise : Description):

	Exercise	Description
1.	IMNEX	India–Myanmar naval exercise

2.	IMBAX	India–Myanmar army exercise
3.	TROPEX	Indian Navy's theatre-level readiness exercise

How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

(a) Only one
(b) Only two
(c) All three
(d) None

ANSWER: (c) All three

Concept behind the question: IMNEX is the India–Myanmar naval exercise; its 8th edition is at Visakhapatnam, 10–14 November 2026. IMBAX is the India–Myanmar bilateral army exercise. TROPEX is the Indian Navy's Theatre Level Readiness Operational Exercise, for which Sea Vigil acts as a precursor.

Checking each statement / pair

✔️ **Pair 1**	Correct.
✔️ **Pair 2**	Correct.
✔️ **Pair 3**	Correct.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Only one* — Wrong – all three are correct.
(b)	*Only two* — Wrong – all three are correct.
(c)	*All three* — **Correct – all three.**
(d)	*None* — Wrong – all are correct.

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** 'IM' stands for India–Myanmar; 'N' for naval and 'BA' for bilateral army.
- **Keywords:** IMNEX navy; IMBAX army; TROPEX Navy readiness.
- **Factual clue:** IMNEX first held in 2018.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Defence diplomacy.

Trap to avoid: Assuming one pair must be wrong.
Remember: IMNEX (navy), IMBAX (army), TROPEX (Navy readiness).

GS-IV: General Studies Paper IV

Q20. [GS-IV | Ethics – indispensable leadership]

You head a government agency that has done very well under your leadership. Colleagues now refer every decision to you, and no deputy is ready to take over. What is the most appropriate course of action?

(a) Continue as before, since results are good
(b) Ask for an extension of your tenure to keep things stable
(c) Leave the problem to whoever succeeds you
(d) Delegate decisions, train deputies and set up clear systems and reviews

ANSWER: (d) Delegate decisions, train deputies and set up clear systems and reviews

Concept behind the question: An institution that depends on one person is fragile – this is 'key-man risk'. A responsible leader builds systems: delegation, trained successors, written processes and independent reviews, so the agency works well even after the leader leaves. Stewardship means holding the office in trust for others.

Evaluating all four options

(a)	*Continue as before, since results are good* — Wrong – ignores the risk.
(b)	*Ask for an extension of your tenure to keep things stable* — Wrong – deepens dependence.
(c)	*Leave the problem to whoever succeeds you* — Wrong – shifts responsibility.
(d)	*Delegate decisions, train deputies and set up clear systems and reviews* — **Correct – builds institutional resilience.**

How to eliminate wrong options

- **Logic:** Drop options that keep power with one person or pass the problem on; choose the one that builds capacity.
- **Keywords:** Delegation, succession, systems.
- **Factual clue:** Rules over rulers.
- **Conceptual understanding:** Stewardship and institutional resilience.

Trap to avoid: Treating good results as proof that nothing needs to change.
Remember: Leaders must build institutions that outlast them.

ANSWER KEY

Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q5	Q6	Q7	Q8	Q9	Q10
(c)	(b)	(d)	(b)	(d)	(a)	(a)	(c)	(b)	(d)
Q11	**Q12**	**Q13**	**Q14**	**Q15**	**Q16**	**Q17**	**Q18**	**Q19**	**Q20**
(c)	(d)	(b)	(a)	(a)	(b)	(a)	(c)	(c)	(d)



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